

DubbiOvi 2.0 — Quick Start Guide

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This guide presents the essential DubbiOvi 2.0 workflow, from creating a project to voice generation and final export. For up-to-date information about the software, downloads, and additional documentation, visit dubbiovi.com.

1. Introduction

Welcome to DubbiOvi 2.0

DubbiOvi is an open-source platform for AI-assisted audiovisual translation and dubbing developed at the University of Oviedo. It is designed for translators, researchers, lecturers, students and audiovisual professionals working with dubbing, voice-over and media localisation.

DubbiOvi 2.0 integrates the main stages of the dubbing workflow into a single workspace. It allows users to:

- import and play audiovisual material;
- transcribe speech using local AI models;
- translate and edit dialogue;
- organise, review and manage takes;
- manage project terminology;
- generate synthetic voices using different voice providers;
- preview translated dialogue together with the original video;
- mix original and generated audio;
- export scripts, project data, audio and dubbed video.

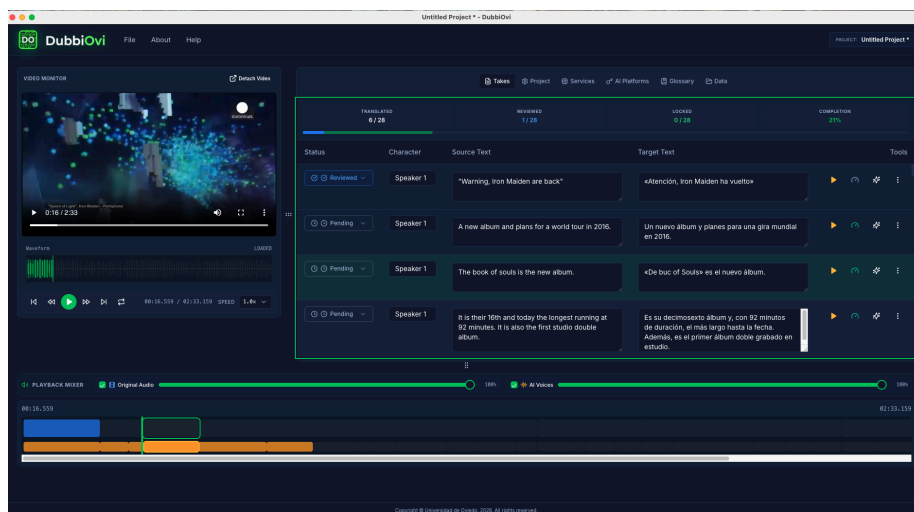


Figure 1. DubbiOvi 2.0 main workspace showing the video monitor, Takes workspace, playback mixer and timeline.

Local-first and human-in-the-loop

DubbiOvi follows a **local-first** approach. Whenever possible, project data and processing remain on the user's computer. Some AI functions can operate locally, while others may use external services selected and configured by the user.

The application also follows a **human-in-the-loop** approach. Artificial Intelligence assists with tasks such as transcription, translation and voice generation, but all generated content remains editable and under the user's control.

2. System Requirements

Minimum Requirements

Component	Windows	macOS
Operating System	Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit)	macOS 13 Ventura or later
Processor	Intel or AMD 64-bit	Apple Silicon or Intel 64-bit
Memory	8 GB RAM	8 GB RAM
Storage	10 GB free space*	10 GB free space*
Display	1280 × 720 minimum	1280 × 720 minimum
Internet	Required only for cloud-based services and downloads	Required only for cloud-based services and downloads

*Additional storage is required for locally downloaded AI models.

Recommended Configuration

For the best experience with DubbiOvi 2.0, we recommend:

- **16 GB RAM or more.**
- **SSD storage.**
- **Full HD display (1920 × 1080) or higher.**
- **Apple Silicon (M1 or later)** on macOS, particularly when using local AI features.
- A modern multi-core Intel or AMD processor on Windows.
- A stable Internet connection when using cloud-based AI services.

- Sufficient free disk space for local AI models.

Local AI Processing

DubbiOvi can perform some AI operations directly on your computer. Local processing provides greater control over project data and does not require an Internet connection once the necessary components and models have been downloaded.

Performance depends on the computer and the selected model. Smaller models generally require fewer system resources and process content faster, while larger models may provide better results at the cost of increased memory, storage and processing requirements.

A dedicated GPU is **not required** to use DubbiOvi or its local transcription features.

Intel-based Macs

DubbiOvi can run on Intel-based Macs. However, **Apple Silicon (M1 or later) is recommended for local AI processing.**

The performance and compatibility of some local AI components may vary on Intel-based Macs depending on the hardware, macOS version and selected model. If a local AI feature is unavailable or unstable, cloud-based providers can still be used when supported.

Internet Connection

An Internet connection is not required for the core editing and project-management functions of DubbiOvi.

Internet access is required for:

- downloading local AI models and components;
- using cloud-based AI providers;
- accessing services that require an API connection.

Once the necessary local components have been installed, supported local AI functions can operate without sending project content to a cloud service.

3. Installation

DubbiOvi 2.0 is distributed as a desktop application for **Windows** and **macOS**. Download the appropriate installer for your operating system from the official DubbiOvi distribution page.

Windows

1. Download the DubbiOvi installer for Windows.
2. Double-click the downloaded installer.
3. If Windows displays a security warning, confirm that you want to run the application.
4. The installation progress is displayed on screen.
5. Once installation is complete, launch DubbiOvi.

Installation is automatic and does not require any additional configuration.

macOS

1. Download the DubbiOvi disk image (**.dmg**) for macOS.
2. Open the downloaded file.
3. Drag **DubbiOvi** into the **Applications** folder.
4. Open DubbiOvi from Applications.

Installation is completed immediately after copying the application to the Applications folder.

Depending on your macOS security settings, macOS may display a security message the first time DubbiOvi is opened. If this occurs, follow the instructions provided by macOS to authorise the application.

First Launch

When DubbiOvi starts for the first time, the main workspace is displayed.

No user account is required to create and manage local projects. You can begin by creating a new project or opening an existing **.dubbiovi** project.

Some AI features require additional configuration before they can be used. Depending on the selected service, this may involve downloading a local model or configuring an external AI provider.

Local AI Components

DubbiOvi 2.0 supports local processing for selected AI functions. The application includes the infrastructure required to use compatible local engines, while some models are downloaded separately when needed.

This approach avoids unnecessarily increasing the size of the initial installation and allows users to select the models appropriate for their computer and workflow.

Local components and models are managed from within DubbiOvi. The corresponding sections of this guide explain how to download, select and manage them.

Important: Do not close DubbiOvi while a model or required component is being downloaded or installed.

Updating DubbiOvi

When a new version is available, download and install the latest release following the same procedure used for the initial installation.

Project files saved in the `.dubbiovi` format should be kept as regular backups, particularly before installing a new major version.

4. Quick Start

Dub a Video in 7 Steps

This Quick Start introduces the basic DubbiOvi workflow. It is intended to help you create your first dubbing project from an existing video. Each stage is explained in greater detail in the corresponding sections of this guide.

Create Project → Import Video → Transcribe → Translate → Review Takes → Generate Voices → Preview & Export

Step 1 — Create a Project

When DubbiOvi starts, a new empty project is created automatically and displayed as **Untitled Project**.

The main workspace is ready to use and includes the **Video Monitor**, **Takes** workspace, **Playback Mixer** and timeline.

You can start working immediately by importing a video or configure the project first from the **Project** tab.

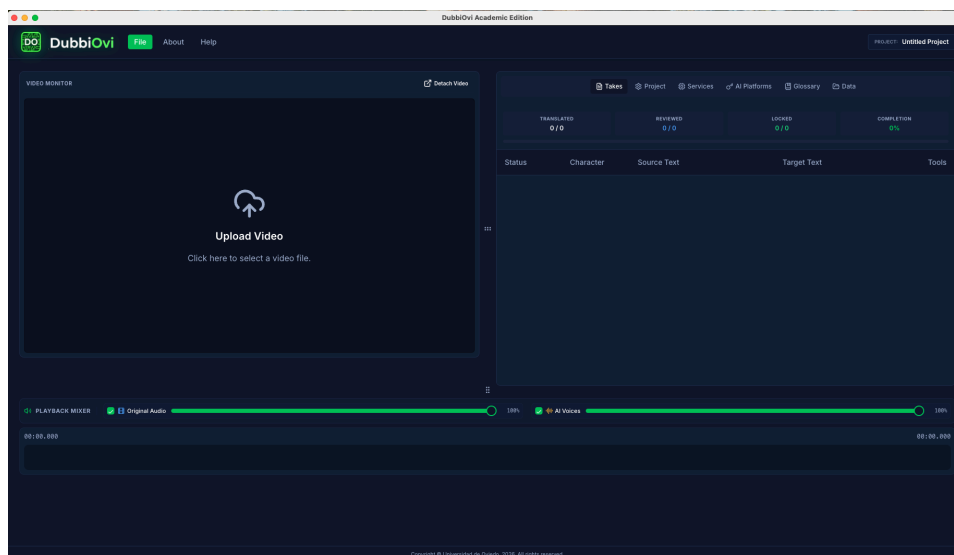


Figure 2. A new empty project in the DubbiOvi 2.0 workspace.

Step 2 — Import a Video

Click **Upload Video** in the **Video Monitor** and select the audiovisual file you want to work with.

Once imported, the video is displayed in the integrated player and its audio waveform is generated automatically. You can play the video and navigate through it directly from the main workspace.

At this stage, the **Takes** workspace remains empty until dialogue data is imported or generated through transcription.

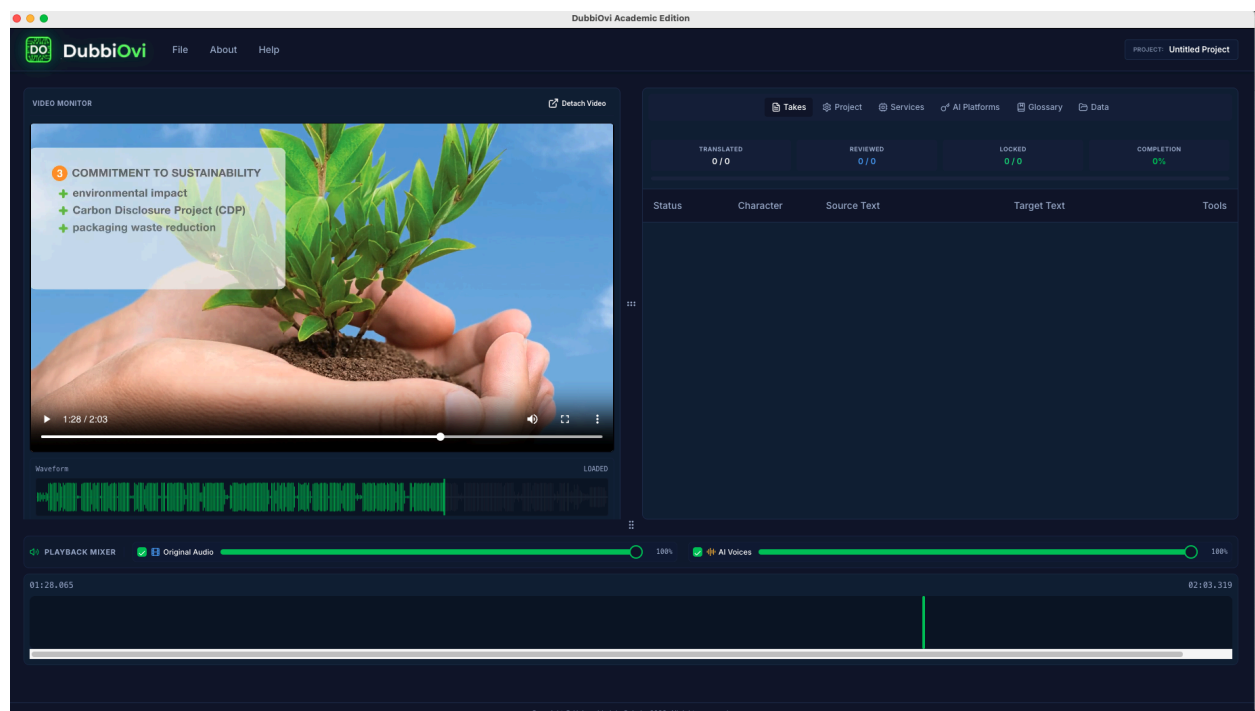


Figure 3. Video imported into DubbiOvi. The Video Monitor displays the audiovisual material and its automatically generated waveform.

Step 3 — Add Dialogue

Once the video has been imported, add the source dialogue to the project. DubbiOvi provides two options:

Option A — Transcribe the Video

To generate the dialogue automatically from the video:

DubbiOvi 2.0

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1. Open **Services** and select the desired **Transcription Provider (ASR)**.
2. Open **Data** → **AI Transcribe**.
3. Select the audio language or use **Auto-Detect Language (AI)**.
4. If you are using Whisper Local, select an installed transcription model.
5. Start the transcription.

DubbiOvi extracts the audio from the video, transcribes the dialogue and converts the result into editable takes.

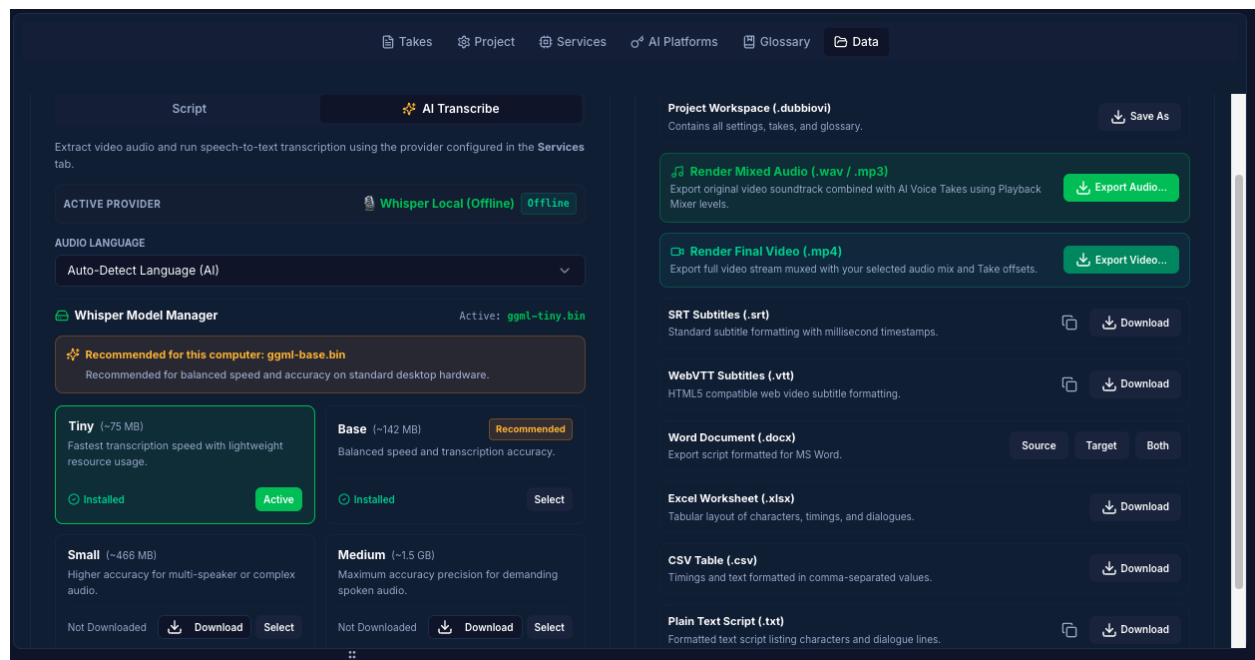


Figure 4. AI Transcribe workspace with Whisper Local selected as the transcription provider.

Option B — Import an Existing Script

If a script is already available, transcription is not necessary.

1. Open **Data** → **Script**.
2. Upload a **.txt** or **.docx** file, or paste the script directly into the text field.
3. Select **Import Script Text**.

DubbiOvi imports the text and converts it into editable takes.

Important: Takes created from an imported script are not automatically synchronised with the video. Their timing must be set manually before they can be correctly positioned on the timeline.

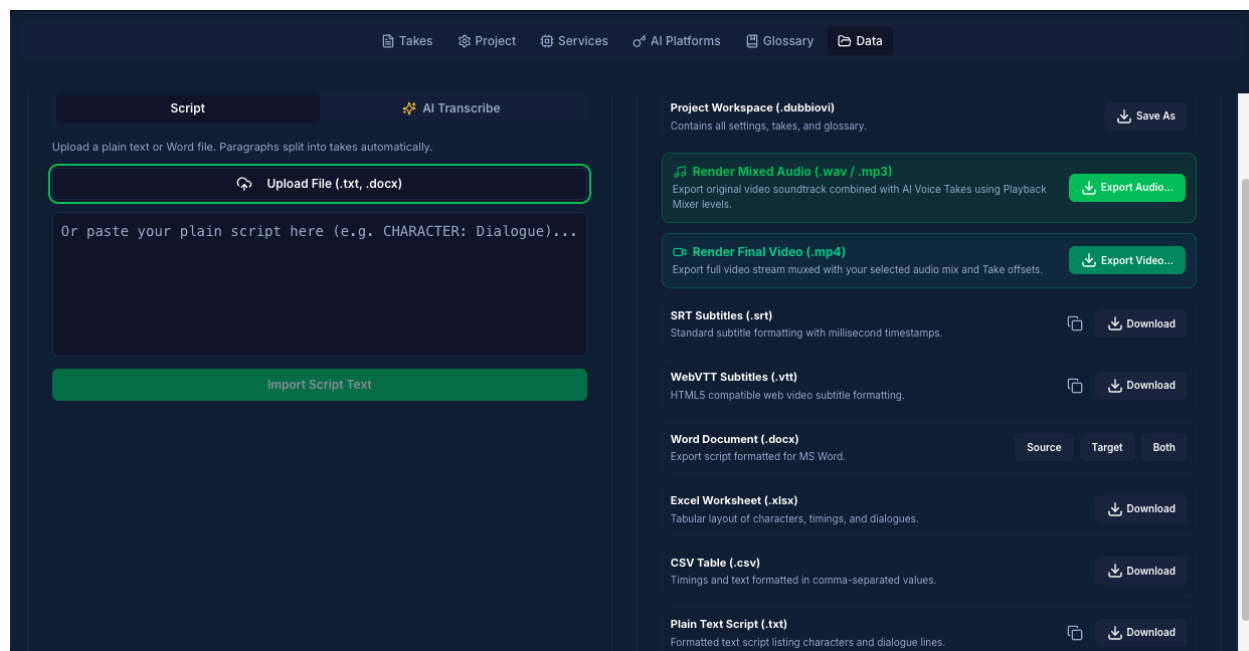


Figure 5. Importing an existing script from the Data workspace.

Step 4 — Translate

Once the dialogue has been transcribed or imported, the resulting segments appear in the **Takes** workspace.

Each take contains the original dialogue in **Source Text** and its translation in **Target Text**. Newly generated takes are initially marked as **Pending**.

To use AI-assisted translation:

1. Open **Services** and select the desired **Translation Provider (MT)**.
2. Return to **Takes**.
3. Click **Suggest Translation** (🌟) next to a take.
4. Review and edit the suggested translation in **Target Text** as necessary.

The **TRANSLATED** counter at the top of the workspace shows how many takes currently contain target text.

DubbiOvi also supports fully manual translation. Select **None (Manual)** as the translation provider and enter or edit the translation directly in the **Target Text** field.

Important: AI-generated translations should always be reviewed before the take is marked as reviewed or used for voice generation.

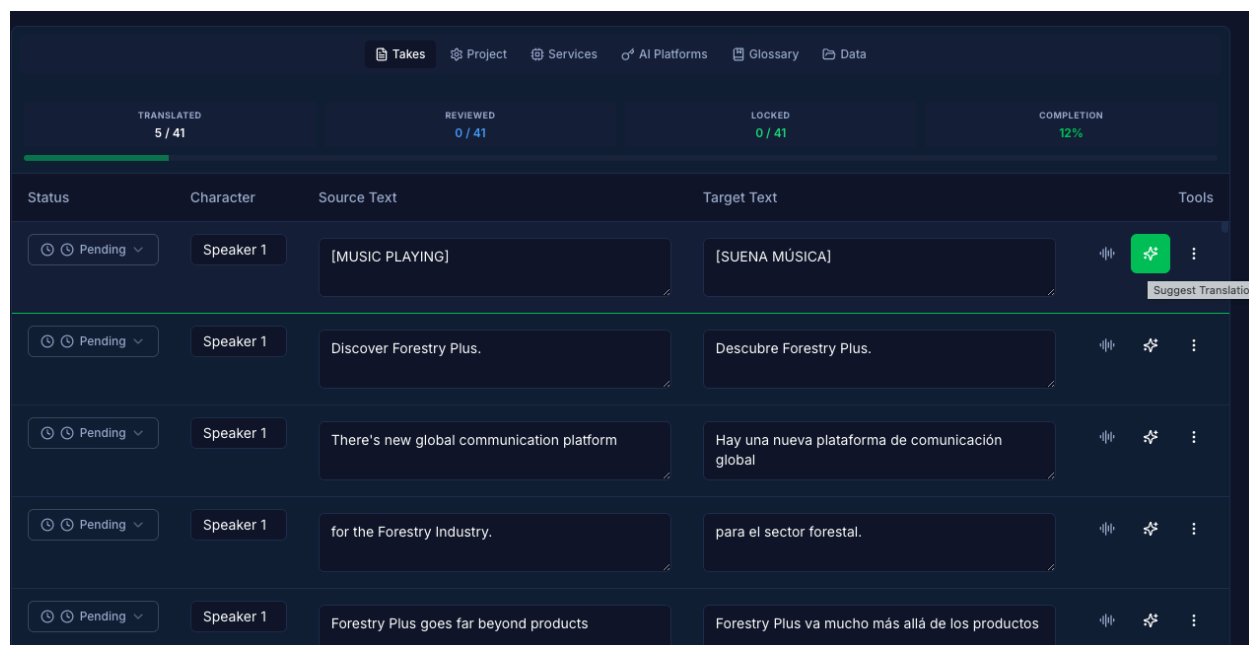


Figure 6. AI-assisted translation in the Takes workspace. The Suggest Translation button (🌟) generates a translation using the provider selected in Services.

Step 5 — Review the Takes

Before generating voices, review the translated takes and make any necessary adjustments.

Check:

- the **Source Text** and **Target Text**;
- the segmentation of the dialogue into takes;
- the assigned **Character**;
- the timing and synchronisation with the video.

If necessary, edit, split, merge or reorganise the takes before continuing.

Once a take has been checked, change its **Status** from **Pending** to **Reviewed**. Takes that no longer require editing can subsequently be marked as **Locked**.

The indicators at the top of the **Takes** workspace show the progress of the project, including the number of translated, reviewed and locked takes.

Tip: Automatic transcription may occasionally divide a sentence or dialogue unit across separate takes. Review the segmentation and merge or split takes where necessary before generating the final voices.

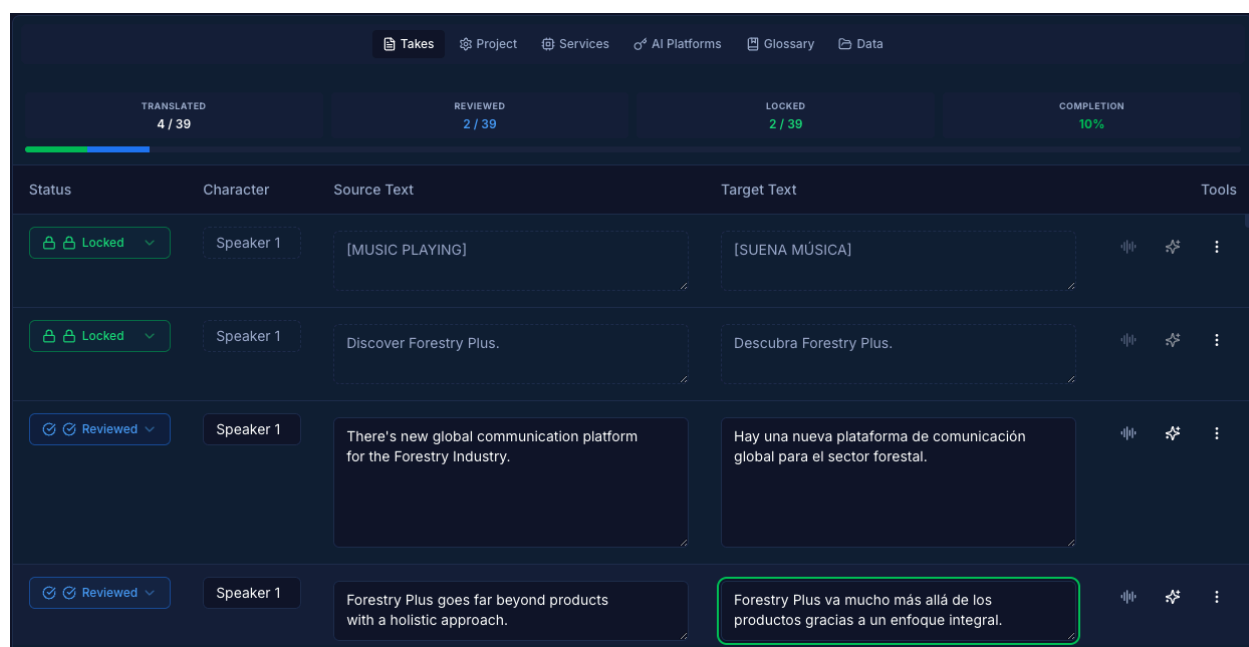


Figure 7. Review stage in the Takes workspace. Takes can be edited and marked as Reviewed or Locked as the project progresses.

Step 6 — Generate Voices

Once the translation has been reviewed, DubbiOvi can generate synthetic speech for individual takes.

Before generating a voice:

1. Open **Services** and select the desired **Speech Provider (TTS)**.
2. Open **AI Platforms** and configure or select the voice available for that provider.
3. Return to **Takes**.

4. Make sure the take contains the final **Target Text** and is not locked.
5. Click **Generate Voice** next to the take.

DubbiOvi generates the target dialogue using the currently selected TTS provider and voice. Once generated, the audio can be played directly from the take for review.

Important: Voice generation is disabled for **Locked** takes. Keep a take in **Reviewed** status while generating or replacing its voice, and lock it only when no further changes are required.

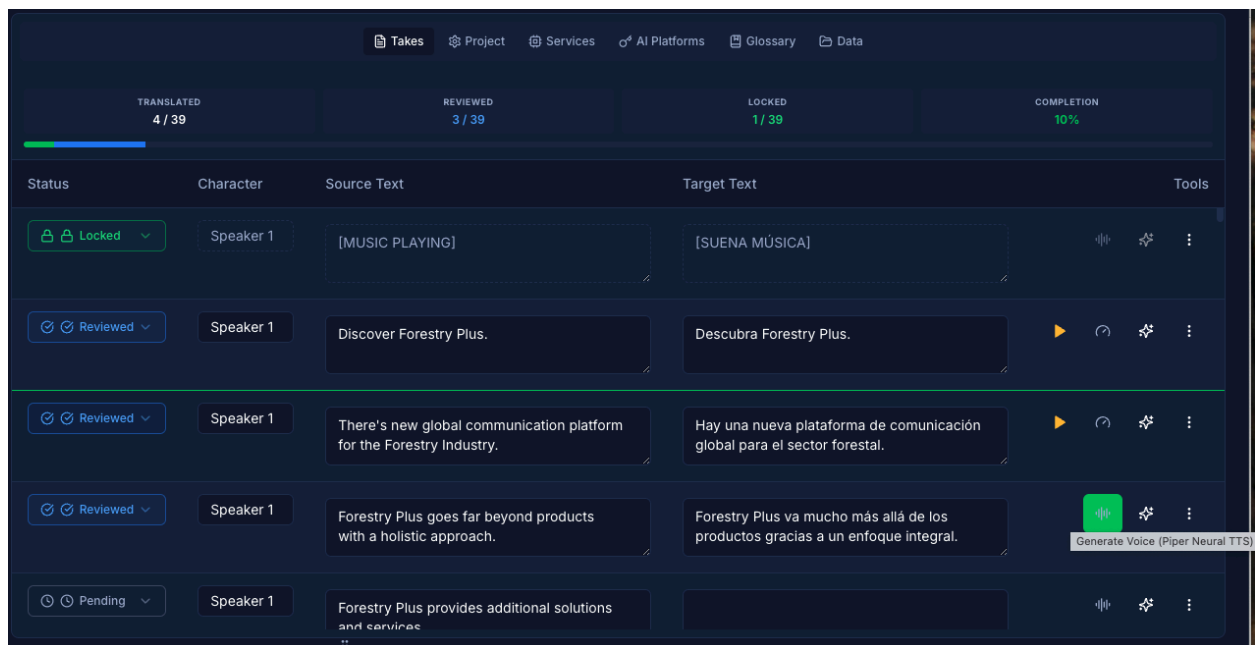


Figure 8. Generating synthetic speech for an individual take using the TTS provider and voice configured in Services and AI Platforms.

Step 7 — Preview & Export

Once voices have been generated, use the **Playback Mixer** to preview the dubbing together with the original video.

The timeline displays the original takes and the generated voice assets, allowing you to check their position and synchronisation. Use the **Original Audio** and **AI Voices** controls to adjust the playback balance while reviewing the project.

Play the video and check the dialogue, timing and audio balance before exporting the final result.



Figure 9. Playback Mixer and timeline showing the original takes and generated voice assets.

Export the Final Video

When the dubbing is ready:

1. Open **Data**.
2. Select **Export Video** under **Render Final Video (.mp4)**.
3. Choose the desired **Audio Track Mode**:
 - **Both Together**
 - **Original Only**
 - **AI Voices Only**
 - **Silent (No Audio)**
4. If required, adjust the **Original Audio Track Volume** and **AI Voice Takes Volume**.
5. Select **Export Video MP4**.

DubbiOvi renders the original video together with the selected audio configuration and synchronised AI voice takes.

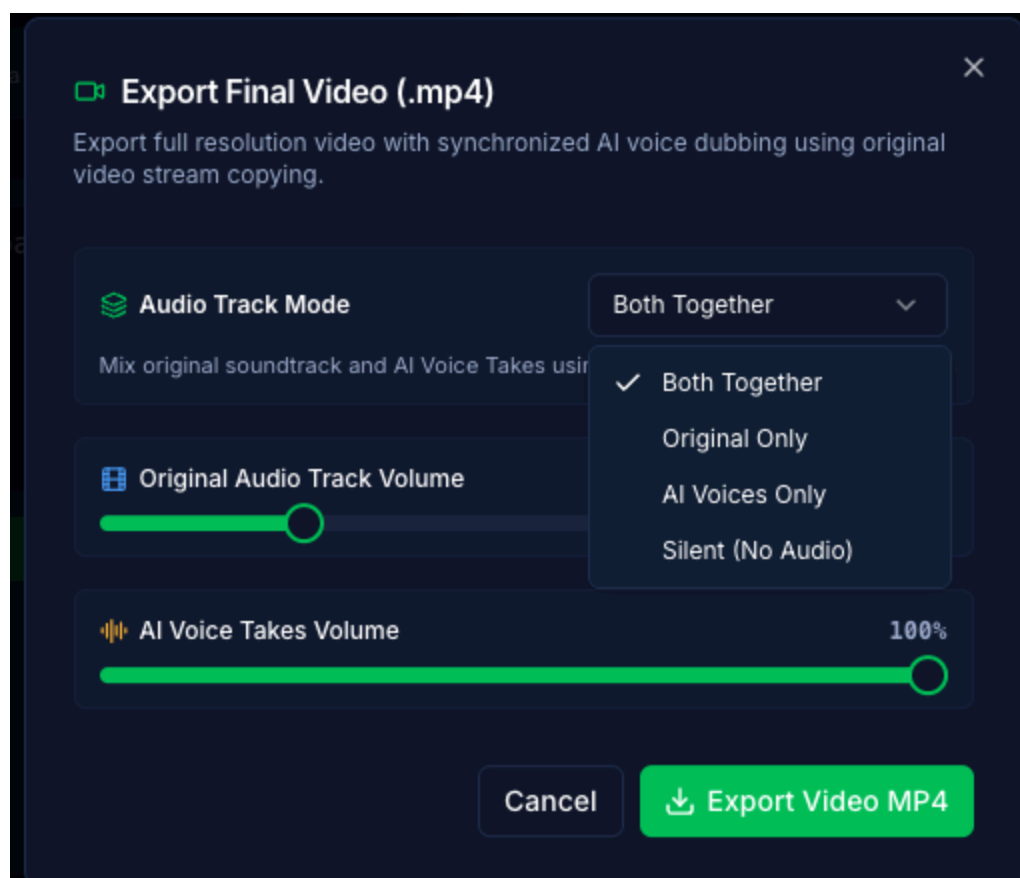


Figure 10. Final video export with selectable audio tracks and independent volume controls.

Export an Audio Mix

You can also export the final audio mix without rendering the video:

1. Open **Data**.
2. Select **Export Audio** under **Render Mixed Audio (.wav / .mp3)**.
3. Adjust the levels of **Original Audio Track** and **AI Voice Takes**.
4. Select **WAV** or **MP3** as the output format.
5. Export the mixed audio.

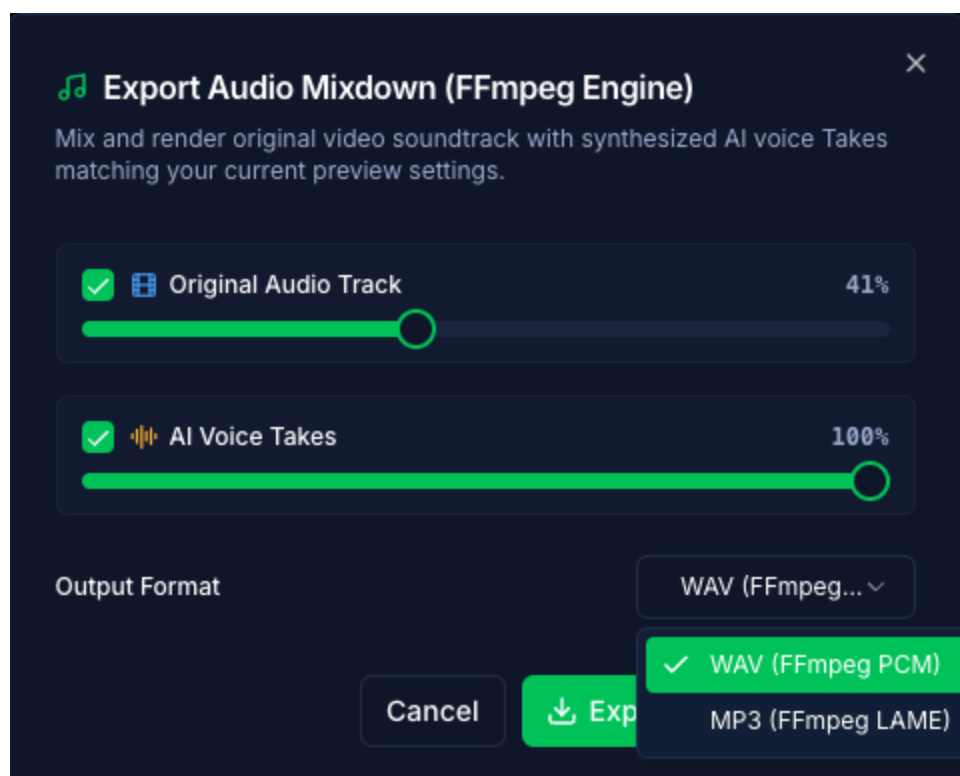


Figure 11. Audio Mixdown export with independent soundtrack and AI voice levels.

Tip: The playback mix can be adjusted while reviewing the project without altering the source video. Check the final balance before rendering the audio or video output.